

A Day in Colmar

Colmar is one of the most captivating towns in Alsace, with intriguing medieval and Renaissance buildings, winding canals, and pretty gardens.

MORNING Head for the huddle of pedestrianized streets of the old town. Wander past the **Maison des Têtes** (House of Heads), with its facade of 111 faces, to the wooden **Pfister House**, which has glorious Renaissance balconies. Then visit the **Bartholdi Museum**, the former home of Frédéric Auguste Bartholdi, creator of the Statue of Liberty.

AFTERNOON Start with the **Unterlinden Museum**, a former Dominican convent full of Alsatian treasures, including the striking Isenheim Altarpiece, created in around 1515 – a riot of grisly monsters and demons. There's a fine batch of gargoyles, too, at the Gothic marvel on Place de la Cathédrale: **St. Martin's Collegiate Church**.

EVENING Walk down to the **Quai de la Poissonnerie** in Petite Venise. Cross the flower-draped bridges, and look down the canals along the rows of houses teetering drunkenly on the water's edge. Stop in a waterside café to sample some *tarte flambée*.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Fly to either **Basel-Mulhouse** or **Strasbourg airports**; Colmar lies between the two, with good rail links. There are also fast **trains** three times a day from Paris.

WHERE TO STAY

L'Hôtel Beausejour (inexpensive) is a charming hotel in a restored early-20th-century building with family rooms. www.beausejour.fr

La Maison des Têtes (moderate), built in 1609, is chock-full of history and Alsatian appeal. www.maisondestetes.com

L'Hôtel Quatorze (expensive) is an ancient pharmacy turned into a designer hotel with hip paintings by Spanish artist Alfonso Vallès. www.hotelquatorze.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.ot-colmar.fr



Right *Tarte flambée* with the classic white cheese, bacon, and onion topping

Below Half-timbered houses sit alongside the canal in Petite Venise, Colmar

